reformed, by God's help, to the original strength of its excellence."[4]

Eugenius III heard the message loud and clear. He promised to crown Frederick as Holy Roman Emperor, the title Conrad had never achieved, in exchange for Frederick's help with a couple of nagging earthly problems; the Norman kingdom of Sicily was encroaching on the papal lands from the south, and the secular officials of Rome (the "Roman commune," the senators who ran the city's affairs) were agitating for more independence from papal power within the city itself.[5]

By the time Frederick arrived at Rome, with a fairly good-sized German army behind him, Eugenius III had died. His successor Adrian IV* (the only Englishman to ever hold the position) fulfilled the papal side of the bargain, and Frederick Barbarossa was crowned Holy Roman Emperor in June of 1155.

But whipping Italy into shape turned out to be a long-term project. The people of Rome were in no mood to acknowledge the German king. In fact, says Otto of Freising, they were "infuriated . . . that the emperor had received the imperial crown without their assent." Right after the coronation, they rioted in the city streets; Barbarossa's men killed over a thousand Romans as they fought their way out of the city and back to their camp.[6]

The mood north of the Papal States was no more welcoming.

Otto of Freising notes, with surprise, that the north of Italy had developed a very peculiar kind of society. Instead of loyalty to a king, Italians felt loyalty to their cities. "Practically that entire land is divided among the cities," he writes, ". . . and scarcely any noble or great man can be found in all the surrounding territory who does not acknowledge the authority of his city." So instead of reducing a single rebellious country to submission, Frederick Barbarossa found himself forced to address the loyalty of each city, one by one. The Genoese responded by building a whole series of new walls and openly defying the emperor. The consul of Milan persuaded a handful of other cities to join him in an anti-imperial coalition. Pope Adrian IV, reading the generally anti-Barbarossa mood of the peninsula, reversed himself and made a treaty with the Norman enemy to the south. He died shortly afterwards, before Barbarossa could come back to Rome and punish him, and two popes were elected in his place; a legitimate pope, Alexander III, appointed by the cardinals in proper ecclesiastical fashion; and an "antipope," Victor IV, appointed by Frederick Barbarossa and installed in Rome by Frederick's soldiers. Alexander III fled into Western Francia and excommunicated the antipope Victor IV, who paid no attention.[7]

Meanwhile, Henry the Lion was ruling the north and east of Germany in